Aofan Wang

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PROFILE SUMMARY

Early childhood educator and researcher with expertise in child development, observational analysis, and designing developmentally appropriate learning and caregiving experiences. Skilled in translating children's behavioral and developmental needs into user-centered insights to inform products and services for diverse families.

EDUCATION

University of Michigan, Marsal Family School of Education, Ann Arbor, MI **June 2024-June 2025**
Master of Arts in Educational Studies – Designing for Innovation: Learning, Instruction, and Technologies
—GPA: 3.90/4.00 | Award: Marsal Scholarship for Outstanding Achievements

University of Washington, College of Education | Department of Psychology, Seattle, WA **Sept. 2020-Dec. 2023**
Bachelor of Arts in ECFS (Early Childhood & Family Studies) | Bachelor of Arts in Psychology
---GPA: 3.95/4.00 | Dean's List for All Terms

FULL-TIME PROFESSIONAL TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Stanford Madera Grove Children's Center, International Child Resource Institute (ICRI) **Stanford, CA**
Teacher **July 2025-July 2026**

- Designed and iteratively refined play-based learning experiences for children aged 8 weeks to 5 years, applying child development principles and observation to support cognitive, sensory, and social-emotional development.
- Conducted ongoing observational documentation of children's behaviors and developmental progress, using insights to adapt routines and learning experiences while strengthening communication with families.
- Analyzed children's developmental, linguistic, and behavioral needs to adapt routines and design responsive experiences, generating insights into diverse user needs across cultural and ability backgrounds.
- Observed and interpreted children's interactions, engagement patterns, and sensory responses to inform iterative adjustments in environment design and caregiving practices.

RESEARCH/PROJECT EXPERIENCES

Project: Social Emotional Learning App Memo (FeelZoo)

- Designed a gamified social-emotional learning experience for children, incorporating reward systems and behavioral engagement strategies
- Translated child development and behavioral insights into age-appropriate, user-centered interactions that support emotional regulation and positive habits, grounded in real-world child behaviors and caregiver needs.
- Iteratively refined design features to enhance engagement and usability, focusing on accessible, developmentally appropriate user experiences

Research: Examined Principal Experience and Racial Identity in Relation to Instructional Time and School Outcomes **Ann Arbor, MI**
Research Assistant in Drake Lab at the University of Michigan, PI: Dr. Thomas Drake. **Sept. 2024-Feb. 2026**

- Conducted quantitative and mixed-methods analysis to identify behavioral and contextual patterns, translating findings into actionable insights for improving learning environments and decision-making; identified a correlation between participation in aspiring leadership programs, prior leadership experience, and increased time spent on instructional practice.
- Contributed to a systematic literature review by exploring how principals' racialized identities shape school racialization and the implications for teacher and children experiences and outcomes; research accepted for presentation at AERA 2026.
- Conducted systematic data sourcing and screening using structured frameworks, synthesizing findings to support analysis and generate actionable insights.

Research: Examining an Online, International Exchange Professional Development Program for High School Teachers **Ann Arbor, MI**

Research Assistant in GRIP Lab at the University of Michigan, PI: Dr. Amanda Brown **Mar. 2025-June 2025**

- Analyzed teacher feedback and iterative experience design revisions using a custom-built AI agent, identifying linguistic shifts, thematic patterns, and version differences to generate actionable insights on instructional design changes
- Collected and organized data from cross-national participants (U.S., Canada, India, the Philippines, and South Africa), including timing metrics and survey responses, to support qualitative and quantitative analysis of decision-making processes
- Conducted mixed-methods analysis to examine how educators adapt instructional approaches, translating findings into insights applicable to real-world learning and developmental contexts
- Collaborated with research teams to refine coding frameworks and improve data interpretation, strengthening the ability to connect user behaviors with design decisions

PROFESSIONAL TEACHING INTERNSHIPS

Mitchell Elementary School Summer Learning Institute Program **Ann Arbor, MI**

Teaching Assistant - First Grade Math and Phonics Tutor **July 2024-Aug. 2024**

- Taught daily math lessons to 6 first-grade students, using small groups to foster collaboration by emphasizing interactive group discussions and peer learning, resulting in strengthened foundational math skills (e.g., counting, addition, and subtraction).
- Designed and implemented engaging practice activities (e.g., matching letters to sounds, building words, and segmenting phonemes) for a group of 4 first-grade students, which reinforced students' understanding of phonics rules and increased their reading fluency.
- Managed classroom behavior, reinforcing positive learning habits and ensuring a structured environment.

Bailey Gatzert Elementary School **Seattle, WA**

Reading Tutor **Feb. 2023-Apr. 2024**

- Tutored 10 students ages 7-10 per week in a one-on-one setting to foster reading engagement by applying active reading techniques like phonics, sight word recognition, and context clue strategies to improve vocabulary, resulting in improved reading confidence and vocabulary.
- Held regular meetings with teachers to discuss individual student progress, sharing detailed notes on reading levels, comprehension, and vocabulary growth, and suggested targeted interventions (e.g., additional reading exercises or reading level adjustments), ensuring a more cohesive learning strategy meets the needs of each student.
- Implemented engaging and interactive reading activities, including read-aloud sessions, guided reading, and literacy games (e.g., word-building puzzles or flashcards), promoting interest and enjoyment in reading.

ACADEMIC PUBLICATION

- Drake, T., *Liu, L., *Chen, H., *Zhao, R., *Luo, B., ***Wang, A***., & *Li, L., (2026, April 8-12). Principal race and the racialized contexts of schools: A systematic review. Paper Session presentation at the Annual Meeting of the American Educational Research Association, Los Angeles, CA.

RELEVANT SKILLS

- Child Development & Early Learning
- Observational Research & Behavioral Analysis
- User-Centered Design & Experience Design
- Curriculum & Learning Experience Design
- Parent & Caregiver Communication
- Data Analysis (SPSS, R, Excel)
- Prototyping & Design Tools (Figma, Adobe)